"Used For" References

H 373

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A. Recent revisions

2026-03: Updated template. Added text related to handling old references for change proposals.

B. Definitions

"Used For" references: Also known as cross-references, see references; UFs.

C. General rule

After deciding which term or phrase is to represent a concept when formulating a new heading, add all other equivalent terms and phrases found while conducting authority research as UF references to the new heading. Place these references in alphabetical order.

Example:

```
150 ## $a Bait fishing
450 ## $a Bobber fishing
450 ## $a British float fishing
450 ## $a Fishing with natural bait
450 ## $a Float fishing, British
450 ## $a Ledgering (Fishing)
450 ## $a Livebait fishing
450 ## $a Still fishing
```

D. Types of "Used For" references

D.1. References beginning with significant words

In addition to the above UFs, rearrange the words of the new heading and its alternative forms so that additional UFs are provided under each significant word in the file position, as long as the resulting combination of words represents an expression under which a catalog user might logically be expected to search. The standard means of accomplishing this is by inverted references, although phrase equivalents of the inverted forms are also used.

Examples:

Heading	UF references
Truck driving	Driving, Truck
Songs, Irish	Irish songs
Mount Abbot	Abbot, Mount
Business intelligence	Business espionage Corporate intelligence Espionage, Business Espionage, Industrial Intelligence, Corporate

Exception: Do not make an inverted UF in instances where a BT is made that begins with the same word or words as the UF or where the heading is in a hierarchy leading up to the same word(s) except as noted in sec. D.7, below.

Examples:

150 ## $a Talking birds

550 ## $w g $a Birds

[The UF Birds, Talking is not made because the BT Birds begins with the same word.]

150 ## $a Freshwater plants

550 ## $w g $a Aquatic plants

[The UF Plants, Freshwater is not made because Aquatic plants has the BT Plants.]

D.2. References from alternative spellings, word endings, etc.

If alternative spellings are possible, including singular and plural forms, alternative word endings, etc., make additional UFs covering these possibilities.

Examples:

Heading	UF References
Door knobs	Doorknobs
Cluster housing	Clustered housing
Glamour photography	Glamor photography
Historic farms	Historical farms
Serial publications	Serials (Publications)
Buses--Vandalism	Bus vandalism

See sec. E below for instructions on when not to make references from alternate spellings.

D.3. References from changed or cancelled headings

If a heading is changed to a new form, or if a phrase heading is cancelled and converted to a heading of the type ***[topic]--[free-floating subdivision]***, or ***[topic]--[free-floating subdivision controlled by a pattern heading]***, make a UF from the old form or from the cancelled heading to the new heading (cf. H 193, sec. D.5.a).

D.4. Upward "Used For" references

Occasionally it is appropriate to make UF references from other than strictly synonymous terms or phrases in order to inform the catalog user that a particular concept is entered under another, usually broader, heading. A UF reference from a specific term to a broader heading is referred to as an "upward" reference.

Examples:

```
150 ## $a Bait fishing
450 ## $a Worm fishing
```

Make references of this type only when it is clearly impractical to establish specific headings for the separate concepts.

D.5. Abbreviations, acronyms, etc.

When a concept is well known both in its fully spelled out form and as an acronym or abbreviation, make UFs from the abbreviated forms if the full form is selected as the form of the heading. Add an explanatory parenthetical qualifier to the acronym or abbreviation.

If a concept is better known as an acronym or in abbreviated form, select that form for the heading, for example, *__DDT (Insecticide)__*. Make a UF from the full form of the heading.

D.6. Foreign terms

In general, do not add UFs to topical headings from their equivalents in foreign languages. However, such references may be made from foreign terms that are in widespread use in English-language sources.

Example:

```
150 ## $a Morale
450 ## $a Esprit de corps
```

Note: This restriction does not apply to headings for named entities, for which UFs from vernacular forms are regularly made when the heading is established in English. When making vernacular UF references for those types of headings, provide the reference in romanized form.

D.7. Headings qualified by nationality, ethnic group, or language

For all such headings, whether established in direct or inverted form, make a UF from the alternative form.

Examples:

```
150 ## $a Art, French
```

```
450 ## $a French art


150 ## $a Mexican American arts
450 ## $a Arts, Mexican American
550 ## $w g $a Arts—United States
```

Note: Make an inverted UF of this type even if a BT is made that begins with the same word or words.

See H 374 for instructions on making general see references from non-used variant forms of national and ethnic adjectival qualifiers.

D.8. [. . .] and [. . .] headings

For headings established in the form ***[Topic A] and [Topic B]***, make a UF from the reversed form (cf. H 310).

Example:

```
150 ## $a Feminism and the arts
450 ## $a Arts and feminism
```

D.9. Topics subdivided by other topics

For headings constructed in the form of a single heading subdivided by various other topical headings, make a UF from the reversed form.

Examples:

```
150 ## $a Advertising $x Newspapers
450 ## $a Newspapers $x Advertising


150 ## $a Strikes and lockouts $x Airlines
450 ## $a Airlines $x Strikes and lockouts
```

E. When to omit UF references

E.1. First word would match BT

Do not make an inverted UF in instances where a BT is made that begins with the same word or words as the UF or where the heading is in a hierarchy leading up to the same word(s) except as noted in sec. D.7, above.

E.2. Diacritics and normalization

Do not make a UF reference from a form in which the only difference is the presence of a hyphen, diacritic, or capital letter because these forms "normalize" to the same string of characters as the heading itself.

E.3. Variations controlled on a base heading

In headings based on another heading, do not make UF references that repeat alternative spellings or variants that are already covered by a UF reference in the basic heading. For example, do not make the UF *__Communication in paediatrics__* on the heading *__Communication in pediatrics__* because the basic heading *__Pediatrics__* already has the UF *__Paediatrics__*.

E.4. Foreign language equivalents

In general, do not add UFs to topical headings from their equivalents in foreign languages. See sec. D.6, above, for exceptions.

E.5. Subheadings

Generally, when establishing a heading for a named entity in the subject authority file, do not add a UF in the form of a subheading under a higher body. Do not, for example, add a UF of the following type:

Example:

```
110 2# $a Filene Center (Va.)

[not 410 2# $a Wolf Trap National Park for the Performing Arts (Va.). Filene
   Center]
```

References of this type are normally made only for headings established in the name authority file.

E.6. Free-floating subdivisions

Some subdivisions that are normally free-floating are occasionally established because of special circumstances. In such situations, make no UFs. For example, the heading *__Mice--Control__* does not have UFs such as Control of mice or Extermination of mice because the subdivision *__--Control__* is normally free-floating under animals.

F. "Used For" references in change proposals

Regardless of the kind of change being proposed, all UFs should also be evaluated as part of the change proposal process. Ensure all UFs, including older UFs, are supported by source citations in the 670 fields, performing research and recording additional 670 fields as needed. See H 193,

sec. D.7 for instructions on how to record research for references that cannot be supported by citations.

Revision history

2026-03: Updated template. Added text related to handling old references for change proposals.